RAFAEL MORETTI-KLEIN

Backend Engineer | Python | Distributed Systems

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer and former engineering director with 21 years of experience across Python, Go and C++. Seeking a hands-on individual contributor role focused on Python backend services. Experience includes fleet-telematics ingestion from 300k vehicles, high-throughput APIs, PostgreSQL/PostGIS and cloud-native services. Recent hands-on coding has focused on Python internal tooling and cost dashboard scripts.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and frameworks: Python, FastAPI, Flask, Django, Tornado, asyncio; Go; C++.
Data and messaging: PostgreSQL/PostGIS, Cassandra, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ.
Cloud and infrastructure: GCP, GKE, Kubernetes, Terraform, BigQuery; limited AWS experience with EC2 and S3.
Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry.
Engineering practices: API development, distributed systems design, automated testing, pytest, tox, architecture reviews, RFCs and technical documentation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform | Streamhaus GmbH | Munich
2019 - August 2026

- Led the migration of a Python 2 monolith into approximately 60 Python 3 and Go services on GKE; playback API availability improved from 99.5% to 99.95%.
- Set up service templates using FastAPI or Go, OpenTelemetry tracing, Prometheus metrics and Terraform modules.
- Built an internal cost dashboard using BigQuery billing exports, Looker Studio and Python; the wider cost programme reduced cloud spend by 31%, saving EUR 4.2M annually.
- Introduced an RFC process, architecture reviews and on-call guidelines adopted company-wide.
- Led five platform teams comprising 45 engineers and five engineering managers, covering identity, playback API, billing integration and developer platform.

Principal Engineer | Streamhaus GmbH
2015 - 2019

- Technical lead for the Python playback API, using Tornado and subsequently an internal framework, with Cassandra and Redis.
- Designed and wrote most of the Go entitlement service governing playback access by subscription, region and device; handled 120k requests/second at peak with p99 latency below 15 ms.
- Used gRPC, Cassandra, Redis, Kubernetes and local in-memory caching for the entitlement service.
- Co-authored the company's service template and Python style guide.

Senior Software Engineer | Nordfels Telematik AG | Stuttgart
2010 - 2015

- Developed fleet-telematics backends ingesting GPS data from 300k vehicles, using C++, Python, PostgreSQL/PostGIS and RabbitMQ.
- Led six developers on the route-history product, combining backend engineering with transport-domain experience.

Software Engineer | Dataquelle Systems GmbH | Karlsruhe
2005 - 2010

- Developed industrial data acquisition software in C++ and Python on Linux and embedded x86 systems.
- Built a Python test harness used by QA for eight years.

OPEN SOURCE

Maintainer, Python retry library | 2012 - 2018

- Maintained a library with approximately 1.5k GitHub stars, using Python, pytest and tox; handed over maintenance in 2018.

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Inf. (equivalent MSc), Computer Science
Rhine Valley University | 2005

LANGUAGES

German: native | Italian: native | English: fluent